

User Manual - Movie Explorer Application

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1 Introduction

The Movie Explorer is a web-based application designed for movie enthusiasts and industry professionals. It allows users to browse a large collection of movies, search for specific titles or talents, and analyze industry trends through advanced queries. This manual outlines the features and navigation of the application.

2 Target Audience

- **Movie Producers:** To analyze box office trends and identify high-performing actors.
- **General Audience:** To find movie recommendations and detailed information about the cast and crew.

3 Application Features & Navigation

3.1 Home Page / Dashboard

- **Overview:** The landing page displays trending movies and quick navigation links.
- **Features:**
 - **Trending Now:** A carousel or grid showing top-rated movies from the database.
 - **Navigation Bar:** Links to “Browse,” “Search,” “Watchlist,” and “Analytics.”

3.2 Browse Movies

- **Overview:** A catalog view of the entire movie library.
- **Features:**
 - **Filtering:** Users can filter movies by Release Year, Minimum Rating, Language, and Country.
 - **Sorting:** Sort results by “Newest,” “Highest Rated,” or “Most Revenue.”
 - **Movie Cards:** Each movie is displayed with its poster, title, release date, and average rating.

3.3 Search Functionality (Query 1 & 2)

- **Overview:** A powerful search engine supporting both movie titles and people.
- **Features:**
 - **Title Search:** Users can type keywords (e.g., “Star”, “Adventure”) to find movies. This uses a Full-Text Search on the backend for natural language matching.
 - **Talent Search:** Users can search for an Actor, Director, or Writer (e.g., “Tom Hanks”). The results display the person’s entire filmography and their specific role in each movie.

3.4 Analytics & Insights (Advanced Queries)

- **Overview:** A section for data-driven insights, primarily for producers and analysts.
- **Features:**
 - **Revenue Trends (Query 3):** A report showing total box office revenue aggregated by year. This helps users visualize the growth of the film industry over time.
 - **Top Performer Analysis (Query 4):** A list of “High-Value” actors whose personal average movie rating exceeds the global average. This identifies consistent, high-quality talent.
 - **Global Blockbuster Finder (Query 5):** A specialized filter that lists high-budget movies (> \$100M) that are multi-lingual, specifically flagging those with Arabic language support.

3.5 Watchlist

- **Overview:** A personal list for users to save movies they intend to watch.
- **Features:**
 - **Add/Remove:** One-click buttons on any movie card to add or remove it from the watchlist.
 - **Persistency:** The list is saved locally so that users can return to it later.

4 Technical Note

This application interface connects to a robust MySQL backend hosted on the university server. All search and analytical features are powered by optimized SQL queries using Full-Text indices for maximum performance.